

Brenden Matthews

Contact & Sample Works

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Professional Summary

Software engineer focused on infrastructure, distributed systems, and developer tooling, primarily in Rust. Currently building financial infrastructure at Ellipsis Labs; previously worked on data and infrastructure systems at Airbnb, Citadel, Braze, and D2iQ. Author of two Rust books and creator of open-source projects with more than 10,000 GitHub stars. Focused on correctness, operational simplicity, and systems that remain easy to understand as they grow.

Technical Skills

- **Languages**: Rust, C, C++, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Clojure, Go, Java, Scala, Ruby, Bash
- **Systems & Infrastructure**: Distributed systems, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Helm, AWS, CI/CD, observability
- **Data Systems**: Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, Snowflake, Spark, Hadoop, Presto/Athena, Cassandra

Professional Experience

Ellipsis Labs *2025 - Present*
Software Engineer, New York, NY

- Own cross-cutting systems across Rust backend services and the frontend application, with a focus on performance, correctness, and reliability.
- Designed and implemented the platform's authentication stack and protocol across frontend and backend systems.
- Define and improve contracts between frontend and backend systems, reducing complexity and making application behavior more predictable.
- Reworked market-data caching and charting infrastructure to improve correctness, performance, and maintainability.
- Harden frontend behavior around authentication, state management, data loading, error handling, and production edge cases.
- Improve CI, testing, observability, deployment tooling, and operational reliability across the stack.

owl.co *2022 - 2023*
Software Engineer, New York, NY

- Built and maintained core product systems using Clojure and AWS.
- Simplified deployment and application architecture while improving reliability and test coverage.
- Mentored engineers and helped establish more consistent development and code-review practices.

Self-employed *2019 - 2023*
Independent Founder and Software Engineer

Built and launched several independent software products, including Fuudi, blogmail, YourHome.AI, and Umpyre. Owned product engineering, infrastructure, customer discovery, and early go-to-market work.

Braze *2018 - 2019*
Software Engineer, New York, NY

- Migrated deployment infrastructure to Kubernetes using Helm and Terraform.
- Built CI/CD and observability systems for production services.
- Mentored engineers in Kubernetes, infrastructure automation, and production deployment practices.

Citadel *2017 - 2018*
Software Engineer, New York, NY

- Built hybrid-cloud data infrastructure spanning on-premises and cloud environments.
- Migrated data workloads to PostgreSQL and improved query performance.
- Built and supported infrastructure for large-scale data science and machine learning workloads using Spark and Snowflake.

D2iQ (formerly Mesosphere) *2015 - 2017*
Early Engineer / Sales Engineering Lead, San Francisco, CA

Involved with Mesosphere from its earliest stages, including fundraising, product development, and go-to-market, before formally joining full-time.

- Built the company's initial sales engineering function, including hiring, technical sales, customer architecture, and implementation.
- Traveled extensively to work directly with customers around the world, helping them evaluate, deploy, and operate Mesosphere's distributed systems platform in production.
- Worked across engineering, product, and sales to translate customer requirements into product direction and technical solutions.
- Made substantial contributions to Apache Mesos and built major parts of the commercial platform around Mesos, Marathon, and Chronos.
- Played a central role in turning the company from an open-source infrastructure project into an enterprise software business.

Airbnb *2013 - 2015*
Software Engineer, Data Infrastructure, San Francisco, CA

- Built large-scale data processing systems using Spark, Hadoop, and Mesos.
- Contributed to the early development and internal adoption of Apache Airflow and Apache Superset.
- Built automated data validation systems that substantially reduced pipeline failures.
- Improved analytical query performance by redesigning storage and retrieval systems.

Newfield Wireless (now NETSCOUT) *2009 - 2012*
Software Engineer, Berkeley, CA

- Built real-time 3GPP LTE network capture and parsing systems.
- Designed a custom database and query language for analyzing streaming telecommunications records.
- Built high-performance data-processing and communications libraries in C++ and Python.

Real Time Measurements *2003 - 2009*
Software Engineer, Calgary, AB

- Built desktop applications, web services, and embedded software for industrial measurement systems.
- Managed servers and automated internal infrastructure, deployments, and operational tasks.

Open Source Contributions

- Member of the Apache Software Foundation and former Apache Mesos PMC member; contributor to Apache Airflow, Kafka, Mesos, Spark, Superset, and other projects.
- Creator and maintainer of **Conky**, **ThetaGang**, and **dryoc**, with more than 10,000 combined GitHub stars.

Published Works

- *Code Like a Pro in Rust*, Manning, February 2024 ISBN 9781617299643
- *Idiomatic Rust: Code like a Rustacean*, Manning, August 2024 ISBN 9781633437463

Public Speaking

- Speaker at All Things Open, QCon, LinuxCon, ContainerCon, MesosCon, and private technical events.

The source for this resume is available at github.com/brndnmtthws/resume.